



Bulletin

Last updated 23-08-2026 at 10:20 – Covering sources published on 22 and 23 August 2026

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · INCLUSION · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies plans and policies

Islamic counter terrorism coalition launches Somalia programme with training for journalists and social media influencers — Somali National News Agency (SONNA), 22 August 2026

SOMALIA

A counter-terrorism coalition launched a programme of projects across 21 Somali government institutions running to 2027, opening with a three-day media-and-peace training for 40 journalists and social-media influencers. The defence minister claimed the closure of hundreds of extremist websites and accounts without giving a period or naming who carried them out; no budget has been published for any project. *Also under [Cybersecurity](#) and [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#).*

Guinée : Mamady Doumbouya pour succéder au ministre de l'Économie numérique limogé ? — Digital Business Africa, 22 August 2026

GUINEA

Guinea's president dismissed the minister of communication, the digital economy and innovation on 21 August, alongside the employment minister, leaving the digital portfolio without a substantive holder. Named successors in circulation are the publication's own speculation.

Digitizing medical records: Ministry of Health on track to digitize health sector — NTV Uganda, 22 August 2026

UGANDA

Uganda's health ministry says it is on track against a ten-year roadmap to digitise the health sector, and convened a providers' forum with a private technology partner on health information systems. No delivery figure or milestone against the roadmap was given. *Also under [Sectoral management information systems](#) and [Data Exchange](#).*

Legislation and regulation

Commande publique en Guinée : Mamadi Doumbouya fixe les modalités de dématérialisation — Guinee360, 22 August 2026

GUINEA

Guinea's president fixed by decree the rules for dematerialising public procurement under article 56 of the 2019 procurement code: a national electronic platform for public contracts and public-private partnerships managed by the finance ministry, with mandatory registration of contracting authorities and bidders and encrypted bid submission. *Also under [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#).*

Data protection

Cyber security agency warns against hate speech, cyberbullying — Zambia Monitor, 22 August 2026

ZAMBIA

Zambia's cyber security agency warned publicly of an increase in hate speech, cyberbullying and insulting online content around the recently held general elections, reminding the public that creating, publishing, forwarding, reposting or deliberately amplifying unlawful content may constitute an offence. *Also under [Cybersecurity](#) and [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#).*

Regional collaboration

Fonds pour la Transformation Digitale en Afrique de l'Ouest (FTD) - le site du programme BOAD/KfW — BOAD (Banque Ouest Africaine de Developpement) / KfW Entwicklungsbank, 23 August 2026

BENIN

BURKINA FASO

CÔTE D'IVOIRE

GUINEA-BISSAU

MALI

NIGER

SENEGAL

TOGO

The West African development bank and its German counterpart put the programme documentation for their Digital Transformation Fund on a standing site, setting out a facility that lends to public administrations across the eight WAEMU states to modernise and secure their information systems. Projects run to a maximum of 24 months against a ceiling of 2,500 million FCFA at a stated 2.2 per cent, with partial state co-financing obligatory and a named focal point in each member state. No date of signature or entry into force is given anywhere on the site, and no country allocation or committed total is published. *Also under [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#), [New investments](#) and [Cybersecurity](#).*

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Tunisia: A Fintech Ecosystem Caught Between Cash and Code — The Fintech Times, 22 August 2026

TUNISIA

An analysis of why Tunisia has not become the North African fintech hub its educated workforce, established financial institutions, Startup Act, regulatory sandbox and geography would predict. The piece traces the gap to the persistence of cash rather than to any absence of policy instruments. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#) and [Access to services](#).*

The hidden cost of South Africa's AI boom — Business Day, 22 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa's rapid data-centre expansion has come under scrutiny from the national human rights commission, with environmental groups warning about the power the country's artificial-intelligence ambitions will need. No terms of reference or reporting deadline for the inquiry have been published. *Also under [Data Storage, AI and Energy](#).*

Fracture numerique : le Togo plaide pour l'open source et une nouvelle narration de l'Afrique — Republique Togolaise, 22 August 2026

TOGO

Togo's communications minister argued at a China-Africa media forum in Beijing that open-source technology offers the continent a route past language barriers to digital solutions fitted to local needs, framing the digital divide as a question of who writes the software rather than who owns the hardware. *Also under [Digital divides](#), [China activities](#) and [AI](#).*

3.5m missing births: how hospitals can close Nigeria birth registration gap — Vanguard, 22 August 2026

NIGERIA

An estimated 3.5 million children across seven southern Nigerian states hold no birth certificate, and the switch to identity-linked digital registration, with paper discontinued on 1 July 2026, has stalled at the health-facility layer: none of 371 targeted facilities is live despite completed training, with zero birth notifications recorded in the reporting year and 120,469 certificates issued against 443,162 registrations. *Also under [Registries](#) and [Access to services](#).*

Islamic counter terrorism coalition launches Somalia programme with training for journalists and social media influencers — Somali National News Agency (SONNA), 22 August 2026

SOMALIA

Summarised under [Strategies plans and policies](#).

Cyber security agency warns against hate speech, cyberbullying — Zambia Monitor, 22 August 2026

ZAMBIA

Summarised under [Data protection](#).

Finance

New investments

Nigerian Government Approves NIGCOMSAT-2A, 2B Satellites To Expand Broadband, Strengthen National Security — Sahara Reporters, 22 August 2026

NIGERIA

Nigeria's Federal Executive Council approved the acquisition and deployment of two high-throughput communications satellites, to be delivered by Thales Alenia Space and Israel Aerospace Industries with the state satellite company implementing. No contract value, timetable or launch date was published, and contract finalisation is still ahead. *Also under [Connectivity](#) and [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#).*

Ethio Telecom holds discussions with CDP leadership in Italy — TechReviewAfrica, 22 August 2026

ETHIOPIA

Ethio Telecom's chief executive met the leadership of Italy's state development bank in Rome to explore strategic collaboration and financing for the operator's digital transformation projects. The page carries no publication date and is dated by retrieval. *Also under [EU activities](#) and [Data Storage](#).*

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ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

STARLINK LANDS IN UGANDA! Roke Telkom, Paratus Uganda First To Fire Up Satellite Internet — Red Pepper, 22 August 2026 UGANDA

Starlink went live in Uganda, with two domestic providers the first to switch the service on. It follows the regulator's memorandum and operational licence agreement of 15 May 2026, whose conditions include a national gateway, a physical point of presence, a staffed local office and registration of every in-country device. *Also under [Digital divides](#).*

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Data Storage

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Energy

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Cybersecurity

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Summarised under [Data protection](#).

DPI

Data Exchange

MESOB Center Services - Organizations, Services, Requirements, Fees & Processing Time — FDRE MESOB Service, 23 August 2026 ETHIOPIA

Ethiopia's unified public-service platform publishes its own service catalogue, stating 180-plus government services drawn from 23 named institutions among them the customs commission, the health, justice and transport ministries, the food and drug authority and the state telecommunications operator, each listed with its required documents, fee and processing time. The count is an order of magnitude below the more than 2,200 services a government account of August 2026 attributed to the platform, and the base cannot reconcile the two on the same basis. *Also under [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#) and [Access to services](#).*

Digitizing medical records: Ministry of Health on track to digitize health sector — NTV Uganda, 22 August 2026 UGANDA

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Digital Payments and Fintech

Paiement électronique : L'Algerie franchit un cap et accelere sa mue numerique — Alger 16, 22 August 2026 ALGERIA

Algeria passed 1,000 connected web merchants at the end of June 2026, alongside reported growth in online payments, mobile payment and card acceptance in physical shops over the first half of the year. The half-year indicators are reported in narrative form rather than as a published series. *Also under [Access to services](#).*

He started Bitoshi as a student with an \$11.12 allowance. Now it has 60,000 users — TechCabal, 22 August 2026 NIGERIA

Bitoshi, a Nigerian crypto-payments startup, has reached roughly 60,000 users on a founder's account of building settlement rails around the Central Bank of Nigeria's February 2021 direction that banks and other financial institutions close the accounts of crypto businesses. Denied a bank rail, it paid naira out through an algorithmic queue that dispatched transfers across a pool of vendors, and moved to an automated payment-partner integration only after the CBN lifted the restriction in 2023. The founder puts users at about 100 in 2021 and 10,000 by 2023, and transaction volume at about \$100,000 rising to some \$5 million after that integration. *Also under [Innovation ecosystem](#).*

Govt claims K1.4 billion to be spent in July, August under Social Cash Transfer Programme — Zambia Monitor, 22 August 2026 ZAMBIA

Zambia began disbursing more than K1.4 billion to over 1.5 million beneficiary households in the July-August 2026 social cash transfer cycle, redeemable through beneficiaries' own payment service providers over four weeks. Also under [Access to services](#).

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TUNISIA

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Registries

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Other GovTech and e-Gov

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Technology

AI

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Innovation ecosystem

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Inclusion

Access to services

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Digital divides

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Geopolitics

China activities

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EU activities

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-23-2
RETENTION	Kept until 2026-08-30. Older bulletins: the country pages and the monthly reports.
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/bulletin/corpus-bulletin-2026-08-23-2.pdf
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0

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Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country pages and the monthly reports.